

Markdown

What is Markdown?

Markdown is a *lightweight markup language* that you can use to add formatting elements to plaintext text documents. Created by *John Gruber in 2004*, **Markdown** is now one of the world's most popular markup language. Using **Markdown** is different than using a WYSIWYG editor. In an application like Microsoft Word, you click buttons to format words and phrases, and the changes are visible immediately. **Markdown** isn't like that. When you create a **Markdown**-formatted file, you add **Markdown** syntax to the text to indicate which words and phrases should look different.

Why Use Markdown?

Markdown can be used for everything. People use it to create websites, documents, notes, books, presentations, email messages, and technical documentation.

Markdown is portable. Files containing **Markdown**-formatted text can be opened using virtually any application.

Markdown is platform independent. You can create **Markdown**-formatted text on any device running any operating system.

Markdown is future proof. Even if the application you're using stops working at some point in the future, you'll still be able to read your **Markdown**-formatted text using a text editing application.

Markdown is everywhere. *Websites like Reddit and GitHub support Markdown***, and lots of desktop and web-based applications support it.